

## SANTIAGO TOBÓN, PHD

Professor of Economics, School of Finance, Economics and Government, Universidad EAFIT  
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### ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

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2020– Professor of Economics (tenured), Universidad EAFIT  
2025– Director, Centro de Valor Público—EAFIT’s applied policy research center, Universidad EAFIT  
2019–20 Professor of Economics (untentured), Universidad EAFIT  
2024 Visiting Scholar, UNU – World Institute for Development Economics Research, Helsinki  
2023 Visiting Scholar, Inter-American Development Bank, Washington, DC  
2022 Visiting Professor, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy, Chicago  
2017–19 Postdoctoral Scholar, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy & Innovations for Poverty Action  
2016–17 Doctoral Scholar, Innovations for Poverty Action  
2016 Visiting Doctoral Student, University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy

### OTHER AFFILIATIONS

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2026– Chair, AL CAPONE—América Latina Crime and Policy Network  
2024– Non-Resident Senior Research Fellow, UNU – World Institute for Development Economics Research  
2024– Affiliate, J-PAL—Crime and Violence Initiative  
2020– Academic Member, Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP); Board Member  
2016– Researcher, Innovations for Poverty Action

### EDUCATION

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2014–18 Ph.D., Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá. Dissertation with distinction  
2014–17 M.A., Economics, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá  
2011–12 M.A., Economics, Université catholique de Louvain, Louvain-la-Neuve. *Grande distinction*  
2009–11 M.A., Business, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín  
2002–07 B.A., Computer Science, Universidad EIA, Envigado

### FIELDS OF STUDY

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Economics of crime, Organized crime and criminal governance, Drug policy, Policing and criminal justice, Development economics, Political economy

### PRIZES AND HONORS

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2024 Medellín Investiga Prize, awarded every year to the best research project related to Medellín’s most important development challenges  
2020 Juan Luis Londoño Medal, awarded every two years to Colombians of 40 years or less for the impact of their research and policy work on the welfare of Colombians

### CONFERENCE ORGANIZATION

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2027 Host, 20th Annual Conference of the International Society for the Study of Drug Policy (ISSDP), Universidad EAFIT, Medellín  
2027 Host, AL CAPONE Annual Meeting, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín  
2025 Host, EGAP 29 Meeting, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín  
2023 Local host, 20th IEA World Congress, Medellín

### BOOKS

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2027 *Cocaína: Anatomía de un mercado prohibido*. Under contract, Penguin Random House Grupo Editorial. Expected publication 2027.  
Forth. *Wartime Taxation: State-building, State Capacity and the Role of Formal and Informal Taxes*, edited with Patricia Justino, Zachariah Mampilly, Gauthier Marchais, and Anna D’Souza. Oxford University Press, in production.

### ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

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#### Journal Articles

2027 “Organized Crime and Violence,” with Maria Micaela Sviatschi and Nicolás Cabra-Ruiz, forthcoming at *Annual Review of Economics*.  
2026 “Implementation Outcomes of a CBT-Based Psychosocial Intervention for Gang-Recruitment-Vulnerable Youth in Medellín: A Qualitative Study of Novice Provider Experiences,” with Mariantonia Lemos, Gabriela Algarín, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, *Cambridge Prisms: Global Mental Health* 13: e174.  
2026 “State-Building in the City: An Experiment in Civilian Alternatives to Policing,” with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, *American Political Science Review*, published online April 2026.

- 2025 "Gang Rule: Understanding and Countering Criminal Governance," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, *Review of Economic Studies* 92(3): 1497–1531.
- 2023 "Production and Persistence of Criminal Skills: Evidence from a High-Crime Context," with Maria A. Escobar and Martín Vanegas-Arias, *Journal of Development Economics* 160: 102969.  
 "The Perils of Military Policing," (invited commentary), *Nature Human Behaviour* 7(6): 843–844.
- 2022 "Do Better Prisons Reduce Recidivism? Evidence from a Prison Construction Program," *The Review of Economics and Statistics* 104(6): 1256–1272.
- 2021 "Place-Based Interventions at Scale: The Direct and Spillover Effects of Policing and City Services on Crime," with Christopher Blattman, Donald Green, and Daniel Ortega, *Journal of the European Economic Association* 19(4): 2022–2051.  
 "Hot Spots Policing in a High-Crime Environment: An Experimental Evaluation in Medellín," with Daniela Collazos, Eduardo García, Daniel Mejía, and Daniel Ortega, *Journal of Experimental Criminology* 17(3): 473–506.  
 "The Deterrent Effect of Surveillance Cameras on Crime," with Santiago Gómez and Daniel Mejía, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management* 40(2): 553–571.  
 "Crises Conducting Stakeholder Salience: Shifts in the Evolution of Private Universities' Governance in Latin America," with M.A. Gonzalez-Perez, M. Cordova, M. Hermans, K.M. Nava-Aguirre, F. Monje-Cueto, S. Mingo, C.A. Rodriguez, E.H. Salvaj, and D.E. Floriani, *Corporate Governance: The International Journal of Business in Society* 21(6): 1194–1214.  
 "Community Policing in the Developing World," (invited commentary), *Science* 374(6571): 1046–1047.
- 2020 "Meta-Analysis of Hematopoietic Stem Cell Transplantation in Major Histocompatibility Complex Class II Deficiency," with L.M. Castaño-Jaramillo, J. Bareño-Silva, and A.F. Escobar-Gonzalez, *Pediatric Transplantation* 24(6): e13774.
- 2018 "The Role of Land Property Rights in the War on Illicit Crops: Evidence from Colombia," with Juan Carlos Muñoz-Mora and Jesse W. d'Anjou, *World Development* 103: 268–283.

#### Book Chapters

- Forth. "Concealed Costs: Illicit Economies and the Erosion of the Local Tax Base in Colombia," with Patricia Justino, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Juan F. Vargas, in *War-time Taxation: State-building, State Capacity and the Role of Formal and Informal Taxes*, P. Justino et al., Eds., Oxford University Press.
- 2023 "Crime: Economics of, the Standard Approach," with Paolo Buonanno and Juan F. Vargas, in *Encyclopedia of Law and Economics*, A. Marciano and G.B. Ramello, Eds., Springer; updated edition 2026.
- 2022 "Prisons," with Paolo Buonanno and Juan F. Vargas, in *Encyclopedia of Law and Economics*, A. Marciano and G.B. Ramello, Eds., Springer.  
 "Broken Windows Policing and Crime: Evidence from 80 Colombian Cities," with Daniel Mejía, Erynn Norza, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, in *A Modern Guide to the Economics of Crime*, P. Buonanno, P. Vanin, and J. Vargas, Eds., Edward Elgar Publishing, pp. 55–87.

#### Policy Notes and Reports

- 2026 "The Producer's Cut: Sizing Colombia's Cocaine Economy," with Daniel Mejía, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.  
 "Construcción de Estado en la ciudad: lecciones de un experimento en alternativas civiles a la policía en Medellín," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT, Policy Note 8.  
 "Beneficios jurídicos en juego: la Paz Total y el voto en territorios de grupos armados," with Michael Weintraub, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.  
 "Beyond the Mine: Sizing Colombia's Illegal Gold Economy," Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.  
 "Improving Officials' Use of Evidence in the Design and Implementation of Public Policy," with Manuela Hoyos, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, Pedro C. L. Souza, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, IDB Working Paper.
- 2025 "¿Qué funciona para reducir la impunidad y la reincidencia por violencia de género? Evidencia de dos evaluaciones de impacto en Colombia," with Verónica Abril, Brayan Pineda, and María José Sotomayor, IDB Working Paper.  
 "How to Map and Combat Urban Organised Crime: Lessons from the Medellín Impact Lab," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, SOC ACE Briefing Note 33.  
 "The Political Will to Measure Organised Crime: Why We Need It and How to Build It," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, SOC ACE Briefing Note 34.
- 2024 "Gobierno de pandillas: entendiendo y contrarrestando la gobernanza criminal," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.
- 2023 "Building Trust in State Actors: A Multi-Site Experiment with the Colombian National Police," with Verónica Abril, Erynn Norza, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Michael Weintraub, IDB Technical Note IDB-TN-2790.
- 2022 "The Terrible Trade-Off: Why Governments Must Choose between More Violence or Stronger Gangs," with

Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, Modern War Institute at West Point.

"Measuring Organised Crime: Challenges and Solutions for Collecting Data on Armed Illicit Groups," with Christopher Blattman, Benjamin Lessing, and Juan Pablo Mesa-Mejía, SOC ACE Briefing Note 3.

"The Terrible Trade-Off: How the Hidden Cost of Organised Crime Harms Cities, and What Can Be Done about It," with Christopher Blattman and Benjamin Lessing, SOC ACE Briefing Note 4.

2020 "The Evolution of Citizen Security in Colombia in Times of COVID-19," with Nathalie Alvarado, Erynn Norza, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Martín Vanegas-Arias, IDB Technical Note IDB-TN-2034.

"Gobierno criminal en Medellín: panorama general del fenómeno y evidencia empírica sobre cómo enfrentarlo," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, Benjamin Lessing, and Juan Pablo Mesa-Mejía, Valor Público, Universidad EAFIT.

"Crime in the Time of COVID-19," with Christopher Blattman, David Cerero, Gustavo Duncan, et al., EDI Report, COVID-19 Essay Series.

2018 "What Works to Prevent Violence among Youth? A White Paper on Youth Violence, Crime Prevention and the Mexican Context," with Thomas Abt, Christopher Blattman, and Beatriz Magaloni, USAID Report.

2016 "Sector Wide Impact Assessment on Human Rights: Mining Unseen," with Luis Fernando De Angulo, Camila Miranda, et al., Institute for Human Rights and Business Report.

#### *Other Publications (Spanish-Language and Early Work)*

2019 "El gasto fiscal de la guerra contra los portadores de drogas ilícitas: una aproximación para Colombia," with Isabel Gutiérrez, *Lecturas de Economía* 91: 79–116.

2017 "El ciclo criminal del microtráfico y consumo de drogas: contexto nacional y consecuencias en entornos locales," with Isabel Gutiérrez, in *Territorios y sociabilidades violentas*, J. Giraldo, Ed., Editorial EAFIT.

2016 "La situación del narcotráfico en Colombia ad portas del posacuerdo," with Isabel Gutiérrez, Camila Suárez, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Gustavo Duncan, in *Contribuciones de la Universidad a la Agenda de La Habana*, J. Giraldo, Ed., Editorial EAFIT.

"Evaluación y seguimiento a las actividades de la policía de vigilancia," with Isabel Gutiérrez, in *Gestión territorial de la seguridad en el posconflicto*, I. Gutiérrez, Ed., Universidad EAFIT and CESEP.

"La inversión obligatoria y el crédito agropecuario en Colombia," with Dairo Estrada and Paula Zuleta, in *El desarrollo equitativo, competitivo y sostenible del sector agropecuario en Colombia*, C. G. Cano et al., Eds., Banco de la República.

2014 "The Rational Expectations Hypothesis: An Assessment on Its Real World Application," *Ecos de Economía* 18(39): 37–47.

2013 "Impuesto predial y desarrollo económico: aproximación a la relación entre el impuesto predial y la inversión de los municipios de Antioquia," with Juan Carlos Muñoz-Mora, *Ecos de Economía* 17(36): 173–198.

"Instituciones y cultivos ilícitos," in *Economía criminal y poder político*, J. Giraldo, Ed., Editorial EAFIT.

#### **WORKING PAPERS & PAPERS UNDER REVIEW**

"Education and Youth-Development Interventions for Organized-Crime Prevention in Developing Countries: Evidence, Extrapolation, and Policy," with Martín Vanegas-Arias. Revise and resubmit, *World Development*

"Respect, Neutrality, and Police Legitimacy: A Representative Vignette Experiment in Post-Conflict Colombia," with Verónica Abril, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Martín Vanegas-Arias. Revise and resubmit, *Justice Quarterly*

"The Prohibition Trap: Rents, Violence, and Welfare in the Global Cocaine Chain," with Juan F. Vargas and Michael Weintraub

"From Schools of Crime to Criminal Hubs? Prisons and Organized Crime in Latin America and the Caribbean," with Ernesto Schargrodsky. Under review

"Votes Follow Stakes: Peace Negotiations and Electoral Shifts in Armed-Group Territories," with Michael Weintraub. Under review

"Who Joins Drug-Selling Gangs and Why? Beliefs and Recruitment Risk among 10,000 Adolescent Boys," with Christopher Blattman and Arantxa Rodríguez-Urbe

"Pax Criminalis," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, Benjamin Lessing, and Juan F. Martínez

"Gangs of Medellín: How Organized Crime Is Organized," with Christopher Blattman, Gustavo Duncan, and Benjamin Lessing

"Building Trust in the Police: Evidence from a Multi-Site Experiment in Colombia," with Verónica Abril, Erynn Norza, Santiago Pérez-Vincent, and Michael Weintraub

"How Illegal Income Improves Schooling: Cocaine Production and Education in Colombia," with Ivonne Lara, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Juan F. Vargas

"Do Illegal Economies Reduce Local Fiscal Capacity?" with Patricia Justino, Martín Vanegas-Arias, and Juan F. Vargas

## GRANTS

|         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026–   | Templeton World Charity Foundation, “Empowering Occupational Choice for At-Risk Adolescent Girls in Medellín,” \$250,000                                                                                                                        |
| 2026–27 | J-PAL Crime and Violence Initiative, “Evaluating an Intervention to Reduce Youth Gang Involvement,” \$124,291                                                                                                                                   |
| 2026–   | The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, “The Long-Run Economic Returns to Treating Adolescent Mental Illness,” \$25,000                                                                                                           |
| 2025–26 | University of Birmingham, Serious Organised Crime & Anti-Corruption Evidence (SOC ACE) programme, “Developing Government Information and Accountability Systems for Combating Serious Organised Crime: Medellín Demonstration Project,” £49,253 |
| 2025–26 | The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, “Testing a Behavior Change Approach to Counter Criminal Youth Recruitment,” \$130,000                                                                                                     |
| 2024–27 | Wellspring Philanthropic Fund, Medellín organized-crime research agenda (behavioral prevention in schools, anti-extortion experiment, city-wide organized-crime survey), \$600,000                                                              |
| 2024–26 | National Science Foundation, award 2343694 (via University of Chicago), “Understanding and Preventing Gang Entry: A Longitudinal and Experimental Study,” \$555,570 (co-PI)                                                                     |
| 2024–26 | J-PAL Innovation in Government Initiative (via Innovations for Poverty Action), “Reducing Criminal Behaviors among 100,000 High-Risk Youth in Colombia,” \$157,653                                                                              |
| 2024–25 | Minerva Research Initiative, U.S. Department of Defense, “Youth Recruitment into Criminal Organizations in Latin America,” \$2,200,000. Award terminated by the funder in the 2025 U.S. federal grant cancellations                             |
| 2024–25 | USAID Development Innovation Ventures, “Countering Criminal Youth Recruitment,” \$199,802. Award terminated by the funder in the 2025 U.S. federal grant cancellations                                                                          |
| 2023–26 | Innovations for Poverty Action, Human Trafficking Research Initiative (U.S. Department of State), “Understanding How to Reduce Adolescent Recruitment into Gangs: Experimental Evidence in Medellín, Colombia,” \$285,907 (co-PI)               |
| 2022–24 | Sistema General de Regalías, Gobierno de Colombia, “Estudios sobre pandillas, crimen urbano y gobierno criminal en Antioquia,” \$840,000                                                                                                        |
| 2022–23 | Templeton World Charity Foundation, “Childhood Adversity, Misperceptions, and Gang Recruitment,” \$235,000                                                                                                                                      |
| 2022    | Towards Kindness, “Understanding Gang Entry and Exit in Medellín, Colombia,” \$200,000                                                                                                                                                          |
| 2022    | Inter-American Development Bank, “Building Trust in State Actors: A Multi-Site Experiment with the Colombian National Police,” \$130,000                                                                                                        |
| 2021–23 | Ministerio de Ciencia, Tecnología e Innovación, “Crimen urbano y políticas de seguridad en Colombia y América Latina: Reclutamiento, gobierno criminal y policía militarizada,” \$400,000                                                       |
| 2020–23 | Universidad EAFIT, “Improving Human Decisions through Machine Learning: An Experiment to Reduce Crime by Selecting Inmates Better,” \$100,000                                                                                                   |
| 2020–21 | Innovations for Poverty Action Peace and Recovery Program, “Gang Entry and Exit: Behavioral Biases and Gang Recruitment,” \$50,000                                                                                                              |
|         | Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago, “COVID-19, Crises, and Support for the Rule of Law: Organized Crime in Rio de Janeiro’s Favelas,” \$35,000                                                                                    |
|         | Foreign and Commonwealth Office, UK, “How Organized Crime Is Responding to the COVID-19 Crisis,” \$35,000                                                                                                                                       |
|         | Universidad EAFIT, “Organized Crime in Rio de Janeiro: Understanding Non-State Provision of Order and Justice,” \$40,000                                                                                                                        |
| 2020    | J-PAL Crime and Violence Initiative, “The Other Virus: How Gangs and Organized Crime Are Responding to the COVID-19 Crisis,” \$50,000                                                                                                           |
| 2019–21 | National Science Foundation, award 1851543 (via University of Chicago), “Experimental Impacts of Intensive Municipal Governance and Community Organization on Gang Governance,” \$450,000 (co-PI)                                               |
| 2019    | J-PAL Crime and Violence Initiative, “Contesting Criminal Gang Governance in Medellín,” \$100,000                                                                                                                                               |
|         | Fundación para el Desarrollo de Antioquia – Proantioquia, “Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Map Order and Violence at the Micro Level,” \$70,000                                                                                                |
| 2018    | Secretaría de Seguridad de Medellín, “Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Map Order and Violence at the Micro Level,” \$33,000                                                                                                                     |
|         | Proantioquia, “Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Map Order and Violence at the Micro Level,” \$70,000                                                                                                                                            |
| 2017–18 | J-PAL Latin America and Caribbean, “Strategies and Programs to Prevent Violence among Youth,” \$32,000                                                                                                                                          |
|         | Economic Development and Institutions – EDI, “Gangs of Medellín: A Proposal to Understand Variation in Non-State Provision of Order and Justice,” \$100,000                                                                                     |
|         | CESED/Postobón, Universidad de los Andes, “Gangs of Medellín,” \$10,000                                                                                                                                                                         |
|         | CESED/Open Society Foundations, Universidad de los Andes, “Gangs of Medellín,” \$10,000                                                                                                                                                         |
| 2016–17 | Development Priorities Window – 3ie, “Increasing State and Police Presence in the Least Governed Areas of                                                                                                                                       |

- Bogotá: A Hot Spot Policing Approach," \$280,000  
 J-PAL Governance Initiative, "State-Building on the Intensive and Extensive Margins: Testing Urban Violence Reduction through Policing and Public Services in Bogotá," \$360,000  
 CAF – Development Bank of Latin America, "The Impact of Hotspot Policing and Municipal Services on Crime: Experimental Evidence from Bogotá," \$50,000  
 Government Partnership Initiative – J-PAL, "The Impact of Hotspot Policing and Municipal Services on Crime: Experimental Evidence from Bogotá," \$20,000  
 2016 CESED/Postobón, Universidad de los Andes, "Prison Overcrowding and Recidivism: Evidence from Colombia," \$10,000  
 CESED/Open Society Foundations, Universidad de los Andes, "El Sistema de Justicia Criminal en la lucha contra el consumo de drogas ilícitas," \$10,000

#### **POLICY POSITIONS AND CONSULTING**

- 2025 Consultant, Prisons and Organized Crime, Office of the Chief Economist for Latin America and the Caribbean, World Bank  
 Consultant, Education and Organized Crime, CAF – Development Bank of Latin America  
 2021–22 Consultant, Police Reform, National Police of Colombia  
 Consultant, Policy Analysis and Evaluation, Federación Nacional de Departamentos  
 Consultant, Impact Evaluation, Fundación Acción Interna  
 2020–21 Consultant, Human Rights, Human Rights Office, Presidency of Colombia  
 Consultant, Human Trafficking, International Organization for Migration  
 2019–23 Consultant, Innovation in Citizen Services Division, Inter-American Development Bank  
 2019 Advisor to the Director for Justice, Security and Government, National Planning Department  
 2018–19 Advisor on Monitoring and Evaluation, International Organization for Migration  
 2017–18 Advisor to the Deputy Minister for Crime Policy, Ministry of Justice of Colombia  
 Advisor to the Secretary, Secretariat of Security of Bogotá  
 2017 Consultant, Innovation in Citizen Services Division, Inter-American Development Bank  
 2015–16 Consultant, CAF – Development Bank of Latin America  
 Consultant, CREER-IHRB Institute for Human Rights and Business  
 2014–15 Chief of Staff, Senator in the 4th Committee on Economic Affairs, Colombian Congress  
 2013–14 Advisor, FINAGRO – Rural Development Bank, Colombia  
 2009–11 Director, Cadastre and Territorial Development, Government of Antioquia, Colombia  
 2008–09 Director, Economic Development, Government of Antioquia, Colombia

#### **PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES**

##### *Teaching*

- 2019– Universidad EAFIT: Microeconomics Seminar – Economics of Crime (undergraduate); Microeconomics Seminar – Development Economics (undergraduate); Political Economy (undergraduate); Impact Evaluation (graduate)  
 2022 University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy: Economic Development and Policy (graduate); International Police Reform Policy Lab (graduate)  
 2016– National Police of Colombia (lecturer): Evidence Based Policing (graduate-equivalent)  
 2017–19 American University (lecturer): Policing in the Global Context (undergraduate)  
 2015 Universidad de los Andes (teaching assistant): Economic Theory of Crime (graduate)

##### *PhD Students*

- 2023– Martín Vanegas-Arias, Universidad EAFIT (supervision)  
 2020–26 César Herrera, Universidad EAFIT (supervision; graduated 2026)  
 2022 PierFrancesco Rolla, University of Sussex (examination)  
 2021 Magaly Herrera, Universidad ICESI (examination)

##### *Refereeing*

Science, Nature, Quarterly Journal of Economics, American Political Science Review, AER: Insights, Review of Economics and Statistics, Journal of the European Economic Association, AEJ: Applied, Economic Journal, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Public Economics, Comparative Political Studies, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Nature Human Behaviour, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Defence and Peace Economics, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Criminology, Journal of Quantitative Criminology, Journal of Experimental Criminology, Criminology and Public Policy

## **PUBLIC WRITING AND MEDIA**

- 2015– Public writing on crime, policing, prisons, and drug policy in VoxDev, UNU-WIDER, Foco Económico, Nada es Gratis, Razón Pública, La Silla Vacía, and the Inter-American Development Bank’s Sin Miedos blog  
Regular commentary and analysis in Colombian media, including El Colombiano, El Espectador, La Silla Vacía, and Caracol Radio’s Hora 20 panel  
Research coverage in *The Economist* (2022; interviewed on police reform, 2020), El Tiempo, Portafolio, El Colombiano, El Espectador, Infobae, Noticias RCN, BluRadio, and El Universal, among others  
Podcast appearances: Probable Causation (Ep. 61), The Visible Hand, Atemporal, Stories of Impact

## **SELECTED PRESENTATIONS**

- 2026 CAF Research Seminar, Buenos Aires; Universidad de San Andrés Economics Seminar, Buenos Aires; Universidad de Montevideo Economics Seminar; University of Chicago Harris School of Public Policy; Universidad EAFIT Economics Seminar; U.S. Department of State TIP Office–IPA Human Trafficking Research Initiative briefing (virtual); CAF Workshop with the Laboratorio de Justicia y Política Criminal, Cali
- 2025 UNU-WIDER Tax and Conflict Workshop, Helsinki; West Point Social Science Seminar, U.S. Military Academy, West Point, NY; The Interconnection of Latin American Policy Challenges, Columbia University, New York; Empirical Studies of Conflict (ESOC) Annual Meeting, Taipei; AL CAPONE/RIDGE May Forum, Universidad del Pacífico, Lima; University of Chicago Development Economics Seminar; Inter-American Development Bank Regional Summit on Citizen Security and Justice, Buenos Aires (panel on youth recruitment by organized crime); EGAP 29, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín
- 2024 World Bank Fragility Forum, IDB session on criminal violence in middle-income countries, Washington, DC; UNU-WIDER Research Seminar, Helsinki; University of Chicago and LSE Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice, London; AL CAPONE, Harvard University; EGAP 28, Paris; EGAP Regional Meeting, Rio de Janeiro; Drug Policy Forum, Universidad EAFIT; USAID Latin America Evidence Summit (virtual); UN Financing for Development Dialogues, Academic Day (UNU-WIDER panel), New York; World Bank, Bogotá (Medellín gangs research agenda)
- 2023 IEA World Congress, Medellín; IDB Research Seminar, Washington, DC; UNU-WIDER Development Conference, Oslo; NBER Summer Institute: Crime, Cambridge, MA; Texas Economics of Crime Conference, Austin, TX; Seminario CAF; AL CAPONE/RIDGE, Montevideo; Empirical Studies of Conflict, Bogotá
- 2022 American Economic Association Annual Meeting; National Academies Workshop on Building Trust and Legitimacy in Policing; UNU-WIDER Development Conference, Bogotá; American Society of Criminology Annual Meeting, Atlanta; AL CAPONE, Reggio Calabria; UNU-WIDER Puzzle of Peace Conference, Helsinki; CLEAN Seminar; Urban Violence and Collective Memory in the Americas, Geneva; Conference on Criminal Governance, Rio de Janeiro; CIDE Lecture Series on Drug Policy
- 2021 Niskanen Center Panel Series on Violence Prevention; RIDGE Forum: AL CAPONE; Fedesarrollo; UNODC INEGI Conference on Governance, Crime and Justice Statistics; USAID; Center for Global Development Violence Prevention seminar; University of Chicago and LSE Conference on the Economics of Crime and Justice; Universidad Católica de Uruguay Economics Seminar; Congreso Anual Red de Investigadores de Economía
- 2020 BREAD/CEPR/STICERD/TCD Conference on Development Economics; São Paulo School of Economics; CEPR RPN on Preventing Conflict; University of Chicago Crime Lab; Empirical Studies of Conflict (ESOC); Texas Economics of Crime Workshop, College Station; Latin America Peace Science, Medellín
- 2019 Annual Colombian Economics Conference, Bogotá; IDB Innovation in Citizen Services Division, Washington, DC; LACEA, Puebla; Universidad EAFIT; What Works Global Summit, México D.F.; REDESAL, México D.F.; Behavioral Insights in Development and Peace Building, Göttingen; Economic Development and Institutions Annual Conference, Paris; Ministério Público do Estado do Rio de Janeiro; RIDGE Forum: Political Economy Workshop, Medellín; AL CAPONE, Medellín; Cities and Development Workshop, Johns Hopkins SAIS, Washington, DC; International Republican Institute, Panamá; Seminario CEDE CESED, Bogotá
- 2018 Encuentro Internacional de Observatorios del Delito, Policía Nacional, Bogotá; Households in Conflict Network Workshop, Medellín; Escuela de Posgrados de la Policía Nacional, Bogotá; Proantioquia, Medellín
- 2017 LACEA, Buenos Aires; Economic Development and Institutions Annual Conference, Namur; Economics of Organized Crime, Bogotá; Seminario de Economía, Banco de la República, Medellín; AL CAPONE, Santiago; Empirical Studies of Conflict, Washington, DC; EGAP 20, Bogotá; Seminario CEDE, Universidad de los Andes, Bogotá; National Network for Safe Communities, Tarrytown, NY; Seminario de Economía, Universidad del Rosario, Bogotá
- 2016 Center for Latin American Studies, Stanford; LACEA, Medellín; University of Chicago Crime Lab; AL CAPONE, Buenos Aires; American Law and Economics Association, Harvard Law School; Seminario Banco de la República, Bogotá
- 2012–15 LACEA, Santa Cruz de la Sierra, 2015; LACEA, São Paulo, 2014; Seminario de Economía, Banco de la República, Bogotá, 2014; Economías criminales y poder político, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín, 2012